Jhangvi Tigers, Al-Haq Tigers, Tanzeemul Haq, Al-Farooq, Al-Badr Federation and Allah-O-Akbar.

All of these organisations were based in different districts of Punjab except Al-Badr Federation, which was based in Karachi, Sindh (Mir, 2009). Later, when Riaz Basra announced the establishment of Lashkar-e-Jhangvi (LeJ) in 1996, all the above-mentioned groups started merging in this newly created organisation.

Ideology and objectives: The basic objective of LeJ was to convert and transform the Pakistani state into a Sunni state, using any possible means, including violence. Its policies were mostly based on anti-Shiʿa activities, and it used different violent means to force the state to declare Shiites as non-Muslims. LeJ, however, belonged to the Deobandi sect of Islam, which is considered conservative in its ideology.

Leadership and command structure: Akram Lahori (original name is Muhammad Ajmal) was considered to be the currently Saalar-i-Aala (Commander-in-Chief) of the LeJ. He was originally part of the parent organisation Sipah-e-Sahaba Pakistan (SSP). He joined SSP in 1990. Later, however, he became the founding member of LeJ alongside Malik Ishaque and Riaz Basra in 1996 and started terrorist activities against Shiites in Punjab. It was also alleged that he had established a training camp for the purpose in Afghanistan with active support of Taliban in Afghanistan. He succeeded another founding member of LeJ, Riaz Basra, one of its most radical leaders, but who was killed in a police encounter in Multan on 14 May 2002. Akram Lahori himself had been in the custody of police since his arrest in Karachi in June 2002. The governments of Sindh and Punjab each put a sum of Rs 5 million on his head. He was arrested while carrying live arms including Kalashnikovs and pistols.

Akram Lahori was involved in many serious cases of sectarian killings, with some involving high-level cases like the killing of Ehtishamuddin Haider, brother of the former Federal Interior Minister Moheen uddin Haider and the Managing Director of Pakistan State Oil, Shoukat Raza Mirza.

In addition to the sectarian target killings, he was involved in the massacre of Shiites at an Imambargah in Mahmoodabad and later in the killings of Iranian cadets in Rawalpindi. Lahori reportedly confessed during interrogation that he was involved in 30 cases of sectarian